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Electrifying India

From Mumbai's Art Deco avenues to Ahmedabad's timeless pols, we drive through two cities where history meets reinvention, discovering how India's past and electric future take shape around us



Mumbai

If you want to understand Mumbai—not the postcard version, but the real, living, breathing maximum city—you don't start at the Gateway of India. Instead, you jump into the quiet cabin of the VinFast VF 6, weave past the chaotic traffic, and meet up with Viveck Vaswani, a man who has lived, breathed, and practically produced the modern memory of this city.

Ballard Estate is where the real story of Bombay's economic engine kicked off. Built entirely by the British over a century ago around a massive shipping pier, it's a stunning labyrinth of grand colonial structures, streets with names like Calicut Street, and weathered brass nameplates still screwed into the stone. Back when commerce depended entirely on maritime traffic, this was the nervous system of the city.

As we quietly glide down the sweeping crescent of Marine Drive, the sheer visual variety of the buildings hits you. This is one of the largest clusters of Art Deco architecture in the world, and as Viveck points out, no two buildings are identical. Each facade features a distinct geometric pattern, porthole windows, and nautical lines.

Cutting back through Churchgate, the journey enters the cultural heart of the city: Kala Ghoda. Flanked by the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya museum and the Jehangir Art Gallery, this corner became the haunt of the city's creative community, eventually evolving into a bustling art district.

To top off a morning of driving and storytelling, Viveck insists on the ultimate South Bombay culinary pilgrimage: Britannia & Co. restaurant in Ballard Estate. Over bottles of Pallonji's raspberry soda, we feast on their signature mutton berry pulao, Patra Ni Machhi and famous caramel custard. It is the perfect end to a journey that proves Mumbai isn't just an island city; it's a beautifully preserved collection of stories that never stops inspiring.



We had the priviledge of exploring Mumbai through the screens of film-maker and Bombay elite Viveck Vaswani